

Zenith Admin Guide

A quick-start manual for managing zenithccprep.org.

1. Logging in

1. Go to **<https://zenithccprep.org/admin>**
2. Enter the admin password.
3. You'll land on the **Dashboard**.

You'll stay logged in for ~7 days. Click **Logout** in the bottom-left at any time to sign out.

***If you forget the password:** contact Emily — it's stored in Vercel and can be reset there.*

2. The Dashboard

The Dashboard is your home screen. It shows:

- **Tile counters** — how many submissions you've received in each category
- **Recent submissions** — the five most recent entries across all forms

Click any tile or any row to drill into the full list.

3. The admin sections

Families

Parents/guardians who joined the interest list to enroll a student. Includes parent name, email, phone, student name, current grade, expected entry grade, ZIP code, and how they heard about Zenith.

Community

Community supporters who signed up to back Zenith — neighbors, educators, allies. Shows their role(s), interests, and ZIP code.

Partners

Organizations interested in partnering (sponsorships, internships, dual enrollment, etc.). Shows the organization, contact person, and a description of what they bring.

Contacts

Messages submitted through the "Contact us" form on the site. Each entry has a name, email, subject, and message.

Newsletter

The Comet Trail issues — create, edit, publish, and archive the newsletter that appears on the public site. (See section 5b.)

Subscribers

People who signed up on the Newsletter page. Each entry has an optional name and an email. (See section 5b.)

Updates

The blog/announcements posts that appear on the public **/updates** page. (See section 5.)

4. What you can do on each submissions page

Inside Families, Community, Partners, Contacts, or Newsletter you can:

- **Search** — type into the search box to filter the table
 - **View detail** — every column is visible on the row
 - **Export CSV** — click "Export CSV" in the top right. This downloads every entry in that section as a spreadsheet you can open in Excel or Google Sheets
 - **Delete** — click the trash icon next to a row to remove it (use sparingly; this is permanent)
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5. Creating Updates (blog posts)

Updates are public announcements that appear at **zenithccprep.org/updates** and are linked from the site header and footer.

To create a new update:

1. In the admin sidebar, click **Updates**

2. Click **New update** in the top right
3. Fill in:
4. **Title** — what readers see (e.g., "We submitted our charter application")
5. **Slug** — the URL path (e.g., `charter-submitted` — keep it short, no spaces). The site auto-generates one from the title; you can edit it.
6. **Body** — the post content. Plain text or basic Markdown (`**bold**` , `# Heading` , blank lines for paragraphs)
7. **Publish date** — defaults to today
8. **Published** — leave checked to make it visible immediately, or uncheck to save as a draft
9. Click **Publish update**

The post is now live at zenithccprep.org/updates/your-slug .

To edit or unpublish an existing update:

1. Go to **Updates** in the sidebar
2. Click the **Edit** link on the row you want to change
3. Make your changes (or uncheck "Published" to hide it)
4. Click **Save update**

Good update topics:

- Charter application milestones
- Community engagement moments ("Visited Arizona Educational Foundation today")
- Board appointments or partnership announcements
- Calls to action ("Survey now available in Spanish — please share")
- Behind-the-scenes from school design work

Adding pictures to a post

1. While writing or editing an update, click your cursor in the **Body** where you want the photo to appear
2. Click the **Add image** button (just above the Body box)
3. Choose a photo from your computer (JPG, PNG, WebP, or GIF, up to 10 MB)
4. It uploads and is inserted automatically as `![caption](link)` — leave that text as-is; it becomes the picture on the published page
5. The text inside the square brackets (the file name by default) shows as a small caption under the photo — you can edit it to whatever caption you like

6. Click **Publish update** (or **Save update**) — the photo appears full-width on the live page

Photos are stored securely in the site's cloud storage. You can add several images to one post — just repeat the steps for each.

5b. The Newsletter — "The Comet Trail"

The public **Newsletter** page (zenithccprep.org/newsletter) shows the latest published issue of The Comet Trail. You write and edit issues entirely from the admin — no developer needed.

Creating or editing an issue

1. In the admin sidebar, click **Newsletter**
2. Click **New issue** (or **Edit** next to an existing one)
3. Fill in the sections — each one maps to a spot in the newsletter layout:
4. **Issue** — issue number and month label (e.g. "September 2027")
5. **Top story** — lead photo, headline, a sentence or two, and an optional button
6. **From Dr. Samant** — a short, warm founder note
7. **Comet Spotlight** — a student/family photo, name, and a few sentences
8. **What's Happening** — up to three events with date, title, details, and link
9. **Inside the Classroom** — a short look at a project
10. **Big number** — one milestone, stated plainly (e.g. "100%" + a sentence)
11. Any section you leave blank is simply hidden on the page — no broken layout
12. Photos: click **Upload photo** in a section to add an image from your computer
13. Check **Published** and click **Save issue** — it's live immediately at zenithccprep.org/newsletter

Leave **Published** unchecked to save a draft only you can see in the admin.

When you publish a newer issue, the previous one automatically moves into the **Past issues** archive at the bottom of the newsletter page.

Subscribers

People who enter their email on the Newsletter page are saved under **Subscribers** in the admin sidebar (search, export CSV, delete — same as other lists). The same person signing up twice never creates a duplicate.

Emailing the newsletter

The website publishes the newsletter on the site and collects subscriber emails. To also send it as an email:

1. Click **Subscribers** → **Export CSV**
 2. Import the list into your email tool (Mailchimp, Constant Contact, etc.)
 3. Send from there — you can link readers to zenithccprep.org/newsletter
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6. The Community Survey

The community survey lives on <https://zenithccprep.org/get-involved#survey> and is powered by Google Forms (English + Spanish).

- **Responses go to Google**, not the admin panel. View them in your Google Drive in the response spreadsheet linked to the form.
 - To update the survey questions, edit the Google Form directly. Changes appear on the site immediately — no redeployment needed.
 - The form URL on the site is fixed; if you ever replace the form with a new one, ask Emily to update the embed.
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7. Public site sections

These are the parts of zenithccprep.org that visitors see. Content for these pages is currently maintained by Emily in the codebase — to change copy, photos, or board bios, send the requested changes to Emily.

- **Home** — Hero, what makes Zenith different, core values, community, partners
 - **Our Story** — Mission, vision, why-now, community engagement
 - **School Model** — Academics, AP-first pathway, advisory, Elevate block, career pathways, financial literacy
 - **Our Board** — Founder bio + board members with expandable bios
 - **FAQ** — Common questions, grouped by topic
 - **Get Involved** — Audience cards (Families / Community / Partners) + survey + sign-up forms
 - **Updates** — Blog posts you create (see section 5)
 - **Newsletter** — Coming-soon page collecting email signups (see section 5b)
 - **Contact** — Reaches the Contacts inbox in admin
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8. Common tasks at a glance

I want to...	Where to go
See how many families have signed up	Dashboard (or click Families)
Email everyone who joined the interest list	Families → Export CSV → mail merge from spreadsheet
Post an announcement	Updates → New update
Publish or edit the newsletter	Newsletter → New issue / Edit
Download newsletter subscribers	Subscribers → Export CSV
View survey responses	Google Drive → your Zenith form response sheet
Reply to a contact message	Contacts → copy their email → reply from your own inbox
Add a photo to an Updates post	Updates → New/Edit → Add image button
Change a homepage photo or hero image	Email Emily

9. Quick troubleshooting

"Application error" on /admin The database may be temporarily unreachable. Wait a minute and reload. If it persists, contact Emily.

Login keeps failing - Check Caps Lock - Make sure the password matches exactly (no leading/trailing space) - If you copied it from a message, retype it manually

Update I published isn't showing on /updates - Confirm "Published" is checked - Confirm the publish date isn't in the future - Hard-refresh the public page (Cmd+Shift+R)

CSV export downloads an empty file That section genuinely has no submissions yet — not an error.

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